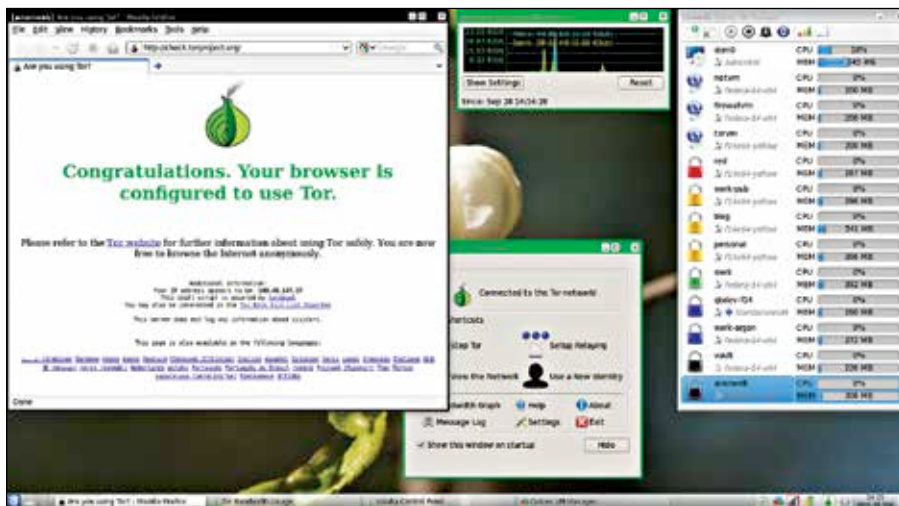




TOR or The Onion Router uses network relays to conceal your location and usage.

the easy ways is to change the way we use the Internet. For instance consider the necessity of the use of social networking sites at all or at least limiting it for only professional uses. The amount of personal data divulged in the form of videos, photos and text is just overwhelming to consider but not for diligent programs which crawl through it all. By minimising your exposure on social media platforms you can limit the extent to which your activities and information is accessible to anyone.

“MOST SPYWARE APPS REQUIRE YOUR DATA CONNECTION TO SEND ACROSS INFORMATION, SO KEEPING AN EYE ON YOUR DATA USAGE CAN ALSO HELP DETECT SPYWARE.”

Another technique useful in protecting the security of your online browsing is to use a secure protocol. Normally we surf on using the Hypertext Transfer Protocol or HTTP unless we are on a secure portal such as those on banks or governments websites which uses HTTPS. By using a simple browser extension like EFF's "HTTPS Everywhere" add-on (<http://dgit.in/HTTPSEverywhere>) we can ensure that our communications with websites is secure and encrypted all the time.

Normally we would tell you to take advantage of VPN or proxy servers to prevent anyone from tracking your activities

but that only goes so far towards hiding your physical locations. An alternative means that is a far more proven and secure means of conducting your online activities is known as TOR or The Onion Relay Project. By conducting their online activities on TOR users can avoid being tracked by websites and snoopers of any type, along with use of the accompanying email and chat options. As a bonus it even allows you to access websites that might be blocked by your service provider or restricted due to your geographic location.

If using a new system like Tor is too much to handle you can try more over-the-counter approaches such as browser extensions. A useful extension to have is Ghostery which gives you more control over how you want to protect yourself (dgit.in/Ghostery).

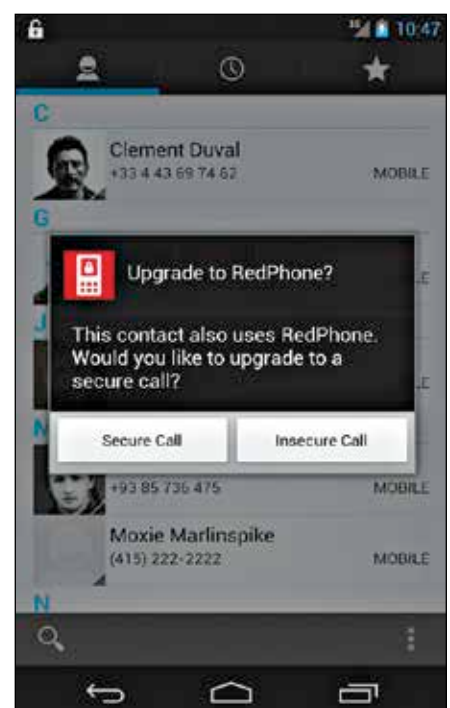
You can either block based on tracker sourcer or websites or a mix or block them all completely with a simple click. Other companies also offer extensions to further your privacy like Abine Do Not Track or reinforce your current browser with AVG's Do Not Track.

A secure browser like Abine's MaskMe browser can also be used to create disposable and fake online identities that include phone numbers and credit card information that act as a red herring between your real data and the internet. A variety of temporary email services can also help in sending and receiving critically private

emails for short durations such as Guerilla Mail, AirMail and 10 Minute Mail that can be used and disposed off so there is nothing left to track.

Securing Your Phone

The most intimate technology used by most people today is their mobile phone. It's the central nexus of work, social, personal and communication activities and is therefore the most vulnerable and valuable link to your data and identity. But luckily it is also one of the most trickiest gadgets to hack by outsiders. Keeping the basics such as a strong alphanumeric password (forget Face Unlock and those Pattern Locks) is a good start to ensuring that if it is stolen or "borrowed" there is some delay in accessing the files. But the occurrences of spyware is an ever growing concern and more advanced hackers can infiltrate your device without even getting their hands on it using wireless connectivity. To detect if any spyware has been loaded is easy to tell if your phone is acting erratically such as screen unlocking by itself or it's battery being drained faster than usual. Most spyware apps require your data connection to send across the information gathered so keeping an eye on your data usage can also help detect spyware. On certain phones you can even install anti-spyware



VoIP calls between RedPhone users is completely secure. For now.